

Word Formation

Process	Definition	Example
Coinage	a new word is created either deliberately or accidentally without using the other word formation processes.	Bisleri, Xerox
Derivation	Adding prefixes or suffixes to a word	<i>happy</i> → <i>unhappiness</i>
Back Formation	Making a new word by removing a derivational affix	<i>editor</i> → <i>edit</i>
Conversion	Changing the word's function without changing its form	<i>email (noun)</i> → <i>email (verb)</i>
Compounding	Joining two or more words to form one	<i>tooth + brush</i> = <i>toothbrush</i>
Clipping	Shortening a longer word	<i>telephone</i> → <i>phone</i>
Blending	Mixing parts of two words	<i>breakfast + lunch</i> = <i>brunch</i>
Abbreviation	Using short forms of words	<i>Mr., Dr., LOL, etc.</i>
Acronyms	Using initials to form a new word	<i>NASA, WHO</i>
Borrowing	Taking words from other languages	<i>piano (Italian), taco (Spanish)</i>

Bound (or dependent) morphemes are those morphemes which never occur alone as words but as parts of words; they must be attached to another morpheme (usually a free morpheme) in order to have a distinct meaning; e.g., -er in worker, -er in taller, -s in walks, -ed in passed, re- as in reappear, un- in unhappy, undo, -ness in readiness, -able in adjust-able; -ceive in conceive, receive, -tain in contain, obtain, etc.

Word Formation Exercise

Part A – Identify the Process

State which word formation process is used in the following examples:

1. Instagram → Insta
 2. Breakfast + Dinner → Brinner
 3. Laser (Light Amplification by Stimulated Emission of Radiation)
 4. Password + Protection → Passpro
 5. Kindergarten (from German)
 6. Bus (from omnibus)
 7. Google (as a noun) → Google (as a verb)
 8. Beauty → Beautiful
 9. Babysit (from babysitter)
 10. Rain + Bow → Rainbow
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Part B – Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences with the correct word and mention the process.

1. Telephone → _____ (Clipping)
 2. Smoke + Fog → _____ (Blending)
 3. World Health Organization → _____ (Abbreviation/Acronym)
 4. Actor → _____ (Back formation)
 5. Friend → _____ (Derivation with suffix)
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Part C – Match the Columns

Words

Processes

- | | |
|------------------------|----------------|
| 1. Xerox | a. Compounding |
| 2. Toothpaste | b. Coinage |
| 3. UN (United Nations) | c. Clipping |
| 4. Exam | d. Acronym |
| 5. Happiness | e. Derivation |